and then charming us by his almost magical powers of persuasion. When we were at the drawing board, he would bring someone from the developed world for a technical col aboration. That was his subtle way of chal enging each one of us to stretch our capabilities.

At the same time, even if we failed to meet certain objectives, he would praise whatever we had accomplished. Whenever he found any one of us going over his head and attempting a task for which he did not have the capability or skil , Prof. Sarabhai would reassign activity in such a way so as to lower pressure and permit better quality work to be performed. By the time the first Rohini-75 rocket was launched from TERLS on 20 November 1967, almost each one of us was in his own groove.

Early next year, Prof. Sarabhai wanted to see me